

Deciding vs. Sliding

I like to describe intentionality in terms of *deciding* versus *sliding*. When you decide to do something, you're in control. You're making a conscious choice about what you want to do, and you're taking the time to measure the pros and cons. You may not get it right every time, but you're being intentional about what you do with your life. You're *happening to things* instead of letting other things *happen to you*. Instead of drifting through life, you're hopping in the driver's seat with your GPS locked on your destination.

Compare that to what I call *sliding*. When you slide into a decision, you're being a passive passenger in your own life. You're just going with the flow, drifting wherever the current takes you. You aren't in control of anything, you aren't directed toward anything, and you have no idea where you'll end up. I don't know anyone who would outright say that's what they want for their lives, and yet that's exactly how they're living. They let life knock them around for forty years, and then they're surprised when they hit retirement flat broke. In contrast, the millionaires we studied weren't surprised by where they ended up. They arrived at the destinations they had worked toward their whole lives. And they did it one decision at a time. Frank and Alice are a great example of this.